Under US dominance, democracy was the expression of partial conquests weighed down by the contradiction of the very high degree of capital and power concentration. At the moment, the capital-imperialist partnership in progress derives and deepens socialisation processes of production much beyond those above-mentioned frontiers. If the international division of labour promotes perverse specialisations (such as the agro-exporting countries contrasted with the countries jealously controlling high technology or, more recently, with unequal degrees of productivity and of labour regimes), more intense and severe socialisation gaps are also growing as multinational companies multiply and aggregate workers from different countries in the same production line. Despite all the anticommunist apparatus put in operation, the capital-imperialist partnership under US primacy and its propaganda expand democratic and even socialist demands internationally.

The internationalised scale of the production process deepens contradictions and brings unusual possibilities such as the internationalisation of social struggles. If these struggles owe anything to the building of international worker organisations, they result much more from the emergence of new and serious issues that transcend national frontiers, such as the question of racism, feminism and, above all, environmental issues (or, in more precise terms, the aggravation of the socio-metabolic crisis). In the latter, the struggle against the nuclear apparatus has a relevant role, just as the confrontation with the ever more serious air, water and soil pollution, which is not limited to the contaminators' political territory. At the end of the 1960s, the fuse of social struggles on the international stage, lit by the French May 1968 experience, clearly showed the tendency of social struggle frontiers to expand.

From then on it became even more fundamental than before (when this seemed 'natural') to limit politics to national spaces while at the same time accepting (and in some cases stimulating) countervailing channels of international communication increasingly in line with national and international ('philanthropic') public and private financing. A 'povertology' sought to skew any analysis (even including statistics) in terms of social class and to wipe away any evidence of production modes reasserted and intensified by social inequalities.

The central forms of social, ideological, political and repressive containment of the popular masses are anchored in states; their importance expanded as the locus in which conflicts could be admitted, as long as they excluded any revolutionary possibility or popular anti-capitalist expression. These had to be de-legitimised and, when they were conducted in electoral forums, they were immediately overthrown or undermined (as exemplified by the case of Chile in